Illustrations

H 1659

A. Background 1
B. Recent revisions 2
C. Definitions 2
D. Types of published materials 2
E. Literature 2
F. Individual persons 2
G. Individual works 3
G.1. General 3
G.1. Sacred works 4
H. Other 4
I. Technique 4
Revision history 5

A. Background

The subdivision ***--Illustrations*** is used as a form or topical subdivision under types of published materials, literatures, literary forms, names of individual persons, individual works, and sacred works for collections or discussions of pictorial representations found in these works or depicting these subjects. This instruction sheet provides guidelines for using this subdivision. The subdivision is coded as a $v subfield for collections of illustrations or as an $x subfield for discussions of illustrations.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Illustrated works***.

For guidelines on place as a theme in art, see H 910. For guidelines on art and fine art, see H 1250. For guidelines on artistic photography, see H 1255. For guidelines on pictorial works, see H 1935. For guidelines on exhibitions, see H 1593.

B. Recent revisions

2026-04: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. Definition

Illustrations: Pictorial representations in published materials.

D. Types of published materials

Use the free-floating subdivision ***--Illustrations*** under types of published materials for collections or discussions of illustrations used in these publications.

LC practice: Use the free-floating topical subdivision ***--Illustrations*** under types of published materials for discussions of illustrations used in these publications. For collections of illustrations in these publications, assign a subject heading for the type of published materials and the topic, if applicable. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand.

Examples:

```
650 #0 $a Newspapers $x Illustrations.
650 #0 $a Paperbacks $v Illustrations.
```

LC practice for collections of illustrations:

```
650 #0 $a Paperbacks.
655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft
```

E. Literature

Use the free-floating form subdivision ***--Illustrations*** under literatures and literary forms for collections of pictorial representations of literary subjects. For discussion of these topics, use the free-floating topical subdivision.

LC practice: Use the free-floating topical subdivision ***--Illustrations*** under literatures and literary forms for discussions of pictorial representations of these literary subjects. For collections of illustrations, assign a subject heading for the type of literature and the topic, if applicable. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand.

Examples:

```
650 #0 $a English literature $x Illustrations.
650 #0 $a Nursery rhymes, English $x Illustrations.
```

LC practice for collections of illustrations:

```
650 #0 $a English literature.
```

```
650 #0 $a Nursery rhymes, English.
655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft
```

F. Individual persons

Use the free-floating form subdivision ***--Illustrations*** under names of individual persons for collections of pictorial representations of the person's written works. For discussion of these topics, use the free-floating topical subdivision.

LC practice: Use the free-floating topical subdivision ***--Illustrations*** under names of individual persons for discussions of pictorial representations of the person's written works. For collections of illustrations, assign a subject heading for the individual persons and the topic, if applicable. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand.

Examples:

```
600 10 $a Shakespeare, William $d 1564-1616 $v Illustrations.
600 10 $a Josephus, Flavius $x Illustrations.
```

LC practice for collections of illustrations:

```
600 10 $a Shakespeare, William $d 1564-1616.
655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft
```

G. Individual works

G.1. General

Use the free-floating form subdivision ***--Illustrations*** under individual works (author-title or uniform title entries) for collections of pictorial representations of these works without text. For discussion of these topics, use the free-floating topical subdivision.

LC practice: Use the free-floating topical subdivision ***--Illustrations*** under individual works (author-title or uniform title entries) for discussions of these illustrations. For collections of pictorial representations of these works, assign a subject heading for the individual works and the topic, if applicable. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand.

Examples:

```
630 00 $a Beowulf $x Illustrations.
600 10 $a Milton, John, $d 1608-1674. $t Paradise lost $v Illustrations.
```

LC practice for collections of illustrations:

```
600 10 $a Milton, John, $d 1608-1674. $t Paradise lost.
655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft
```

G.2. Sacred works

Use the free-floating form subdivision ***--Illustrations*** under uniform titles for sacred works and their individual parts for collections of pictorial representations of these works. For discussion of these topics, use the free-floating topical subdivision.

Assign a heading of this type to illustrated editions of sacred works, to collections of such illustrations without text, and to discussions of these illustrations.

LC practice: Use the free-floating topical subdivision ***--Illustrations*** under uniform titles for sacred works and their individual parts for discussions of pictorial representations of these works. This includes illustrated editions of sacred works, collections of such illustrations without text, and to discussions of these illustrations. For collections of pictorial representations of these works, assign a subject heading for the individual works and the topic, if applicable. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand.

Example:

```
630 00 $a Bible. $p Revelation $v Illustrations.
630 00 $a Qur'an $x Illustrations.
```

LC practice for collections of illustrations:

```
630 00 $a Bible. $p Revelation.
655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft
```

H. Other

In accordance with H 1935, use the subdivision ***--Pictorial works*** under other types of headings for collections of pictorial representations of these subjects. Do not use the subdivision ***--Illustrations*** under these topics.

LC practice: For guidelines on pictorial works, see H 1935.

I. Technique

To works discussing the technique of making illustrations, assign the appropriate phrase heading, if one exists or can be established.

Example:

```
650 #0 $a Caricature.
650 #0 $a Illustration of books.
650 #0 $a Medical illustration.
650 #0 $a Scientific illustration.
```

J. Extended examples

Title: Visions of adventure : N.C. Wyeth and the Brandywine artists.

650 #0 $a Painting, American $y 20th century.

650 #0 $a Illustration of books $z United States $y 20th century.

650 #0 $a Adventure stories $v Illustrations.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Painting, American $y 20th century.

650 #0 $a Illustration of books $z United States $y 20th century.

650 #0 $a Adventure stories.

655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Art criticism. $2 lcgft

Title: Illuminating the Roman d'Alexandre : Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Bodley 264 : the manuscript as monument.

600 00 $a Alexander, $c the Great, $d 356 B.C.-323 B.C. $v Romances $v Illustrations.

600 00 $a Alexander, $c the Great, $d 356 B.C.-323 B.C. $v Romances $x History and criticism.

600 00 $a Alexander, $c the Great, $d 356 B.C.-323 B.C. $v Art.

610 20 $a Bodleian Library. $k Manuscript. $n Bodley 264.

630 00 $a Roman d'Alexandre $v Illustrations.

650 #0 $a Illumination of books and manuscripts, Medieval.

650 #0 $a Illumination of books and manuscripts, Medieval $x Themes, motives.

650 #0 $a Illumination of books and manuscripts, French.

LC practice:

600 00 $a Alexander, $c the Great, $d 356 B.C.-323 B.C. $x Romances $x History and criticism.

600 00 $a Alexander, $c the Great, $d 356 B.C.-323 B.C. $x Art.

610 20 $a Bodleian Library. $k Manuscript. $n Bodley 264.

630 00 $a Roman d'Alexandre.

650 #0 $a Illumination of books and manuscripts, Medieval.

650 #0 $a Illumination of books and manuscripts, Medieval $x Themes, motives.

650 #0 $a Illumination of books and manuscripts, French.

655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Art criticism. $2 lcgft

```
655 #7 $a Literary criticism. $2 lcgft
```

Revision history

2026-04: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.